Introduction

Managing a high school football strength program can be challenging without the right tools. Platforms like TeamBuildr, Volt, and others have emerged to help small organizations (e.g. school teams, local clubs) plan workouts, track progress, and customize training. Below we compare **TeamBuildr**, **Volt Athletics**, and similar programs (e.g. TrainHeroic, PLT4M) across key criteria, and then evaluate how a custom lifting program (from the provided README) stacks up.

Key Features

TeamBuildr: A comprehensive strength & conditioning platform known for workout programming and athlete tracking. Coaches can create highly customizable training plans using a calendar system, tailoring workouts to individuals or groups . It includes a vast **exercise library** (with videos and coach-editable entries) and even allows linking exercises for automatic weight prescriptions (e.g. set front squat at 85% of back squat max) . Athletes log their sets, reps, and loads via the TeamBuildr mobile app, enabling real-time **progress tracking** and feedback to coaches . The platform supports **team communication** (messages, announcements) and offers robust **data analytics** with reports to visualize performance over time . Overall, TeamBuildr is designed to save coaches time in program design and deliver a detailed training experience for athletes .

Volt Athletics: An AI-driven training app that provides **personalized, science-based workouts**. Volt's system comes with 30+ built-in strength programs and uses its Cortex® **Smart Sets™ AI** to adjust training loads based on athlete feedback . Coaches can also customize plans using an **advanced program builder** (available in higher tiers) or choose from 100+ sport-specific and even position-specific programs for their team . Volt emphasizes **ease of use** – workouts include step-by-step instructions, video demonstrations, and coaching cues, making it easy for athletes (even without direct supervision) to follow proper technique . Athletes can log workouts in the Volt app, and coaches get instant **analytics & feedback** on performance and readiness (with features like RPE logging and wellness surveys in premium plans) . In short, Volt provides a ready-to-go training curriculum backed by NSCA-recommended principles, helping coaches implement effective programs with minimal hassle .

TrainHeroic: A platform focused on strength and conditioning coaching and athlete engagement. Like TeamBuildr, it allows coaches to **program workouts** for individuals or groups and athletes log their results via mobile app. TrainHeroic offers fun features like **team leaderboards** to foster competition and **performance tracking** over time . It's specialized for S&C, so it supports detailed workout design (sets, reps, % of max, etc.) and has a marketplace where coaches can share or sell training programs . While it may lack some of the all-in-one business management tools of broader fitness platforms, TrainHeroic covers the core needs of workout planning, athlete logging, and basic analytics well . It's essentially a digital platform to design training and analyze performance post-training .

PLT4M: A platform built **exclusively for high schools**, combining training software with educational content . It includes dozens of **pre-made workout programs** tailored by age and experience (from novice 7th graders to advanced athletes), supported by 1,500+ demo videos . Teachers and coaches can also build or customize unlimited programs to fit their own curriculum . PLT4M's features go beyond lifting workouts – it offers modules on fitness, wellness, and even academic PE content. The **teacher dashboard** allows managing multiple classes or teams, and it supports data tracking (e.g. test results, assessments) with on-demand reports . In essence, PLT4M is a **full curriculum and training app** for secondary schools, covering workout delivery, technique instruction, and student tracking in one package .

Other Notable Tools: **MaxOne** is another app popular in high school sports that emphasizes all-in-one coaching tools – customizable workout calendars, one-touch messaging to athletes/parents, and schedule management in addition to basic training logs . **CoachMePlus, BridgeAthletic, AthleteMonitoring** and others exist, but they tend to target higher levels (college/pro) or broader athlete management. For a small organization like a high school team, the key players are the ones above, which focus on strength program design, athlete engagement, and easy coaching workflows.

Pricing Models

TeamBuildr: Operates on a tiered subscription model (annual or monthly). Plans start around **$60/month (about $600/year)** for up to ~50 athletes (Silver plan) and scale up for larger programs . For example, a mid-tier Gold is ~$1000/year (up to 250 athletes), and Platinum ~$1500/year (up to 500 athletes) . Their highest "Platinum Pro" tier is about $2400/year for large or pro organizations . All plans include the core platform features; higher tiers mainly raise athlete limits and may unlock advanced add-ons. **No free version** is offered (aside from a free trial) , so schools must budget for a recurring subscription.

Volt Athletics: Also subscription-based, with **three plan tiers** for organizations. The **Essentials** plan is about **$80/month** (~$800/year if billed annually) for the basic feature set . The **Advanced** tier is $100/month ($1000/year) and includes the sport-specific programs, in-app team chat, and advanced builder/analytics . The top **Premium** tier runs $140/month ($1400/year) and adds features like tablet mode, more specialized programs, wellness surveys, and a dedicated strength coach consultant on call . Volt's pricing is **fixed per organization** (not explicitly per athlete), which means even a small team pays the base rate – but it can be cost-effective for medium-sized teams since pricing doesn't balloon with every added athlete. Like others, Volt offers a free trial period but no permanent free version.

TrainHeroic: Uses a scalable subscription model tied to number of athletes. For coaches, pricing starts at **$9.99/month for a single athlete**, and increases as you add more athletes . In practice, this works out to roughly ~$50/month for 50 athletes and can reach $199.99/month for 500 athletes, and $399.99/month for 1,000 athletes . This pay-per-athlete structure means small teams can start cheap, but costs rise steadily with team size. (TrainHeroic also has a marketplace model for selling programs to individuals, where the platform takes a cut, but for a

school team the coach-focused pricing is more relevant.) There's no long-term free tier for teams, but coaches can explore features with a trial or by starting at a low athlete count.

PLT4M: Priced as a school-based subscription, **based on the number of student users**. They advertise **plans starting at $600** (annually) for smaller programs . Schools need to get a quote for exact pricing, as costs scale with student count. The key point is PLT4M does *not* gate any features by tier – a subscription unlocks all content and features for the school, and you pay more only as more students require accounts . Multi-year or district-wide deals can lower the per-student cost . In summary, PLT4M's model is straightforward but requires an annual commitment; it is often considered one of the more affordable options relative to the amount of content provided .

Note: All these platforms use **recurring subscriptions** – there are generally no one-time purchase options for lifetime use. Most offer free trials, but ongoing use will incur monthly or yearly fees. This can be a budget consideration for small high school programs. None of the major platforms truly offer a freemium long-term free mode (some individual-athlete apps might, but not the team management solutions).

Platform Compatibility

A critical factor for youth programs (with users ages 12-50, from students to coaches) is that the software works on all common devices:

- **Mobile Apps (iPhone/Android):** TeamBuildr, Volt, TrainHeroic, and PLT4M each provide mobile apps for athletes (and sometimes separate coach apps). Athletes can use iPhones or Android phones to view workouts, watch exercise demo videos, and record their results. For example, TeamBuildr's app on iOS/Android lets athletes log sets/reps and view video demonstrations , and PLT4M similarly has a student app for iOS/Android . Volt's training app is accessible on phones and even has offline capabilities in its premium version . This mobile accessibility is vital for teenage athletes, ensuring they can engage with the program on their personal devices.

- **Tablet (iPad/Android tablets):** All platforms with mobile apps also support tablets. Volt even has a dedicated **Tablet Training Mode** in its premium plan , which is useful for coaches who want to set up an iPad in the weight room as a kiosk or for athletes who prefer a bigger screen. PLT4M and TeamBuildr apps run on iPad/Android tablets as well, or coaches can use tablet browsers to access the web dashboards. Having tablet compatibility is useful for in-gym use (e.g., mounting an iPad to check off workouts).

- **Desktop/Web (MacBook, Windows PC):** Coaches typically design programs and review data through web dashboards, which are accessible via any modern browser on Mac or Windows. TeamBuildr and TrainHeroic have web portals for coaches to input workouts and analyze metrics. Volt has the **Volt Coach Platform** on web for administrative tasks, and PLT4M's teacher dashboard is also web-based (with unlimited teacher accounts for staff) . This cross-compatibility means coaches can work from a laptop (Windows or macOS) at school or

home, then athletes see the results on their phones. All platforms store data in the cloud, so information stays synced across devices.

- **Offline Access & Printing:** High school weight rooms don't always have reliable Wi-Fi or cell service, and some coaches still prefer paper workouts. Most platforms accommodate this: TeamBuildr allows printing workout cards or spreadsheets, Volt provides **printable workouts** for any session , and PLT4M data can be exported if needed. Volt's Premium tier goes further with true offline mode in the app (data syncs when back online) . In practice, coaches often use a mix – perhaps preparing workouts on a PC, athletes using phones in the gym, and a paper backup just in case. All considered platforms are flexible enough to function across the typical devices a 12-50 year-old user would have.

Strengths and Weaknesses of Each Platform

TeamBuildr – Strengths: Offers *rich coaching features* and customization beloved by strength coaches. It's often praised as an "Excel and clipboard replacement" that's simple and fast to use for coaches who have little extra office time . The interface is straightforward for programming and logging, saving time on tedious tasks. It's also one of the **most cost-efficient** solutions for teams, providing a solid feature set at lower entry price than some competitors . TeamBuildr's data analytics and reporting give coaches insight into progress and allow identification of athletes' strengths/weaknesses over time. Another advantage is its focus on the coach's control: you can completely customize workouts, create your own exercises, and adjust anything (it doesn't force any particular training methodology). This makes it very adaptable from high school to pro teams. Athlete engagement is boosted by the app's ease of logging and the ability to share feedback or media with coaches remotely .

TeamBuildr – Weaknesses: It has limited built-in training content – the coach is expected to program or import workouts (though templates can be saved, it's not an AI content library like Volt). So for less-experienced coaches looking for ready-made programs, TeamBuildr isn't as immediately helpful. Communication tools, while present, are somewhat **basic** (sufficient for simple messages but not a full social platform) . As a smaller company, some advanced "sport science" features (like wellness surveys or device integrations) might be less robust compared to enterprise systems. Additionally, while the interface is intuitive, new users still face a learning curve to utilize all features (due to its depth). Finally, there's a cost barrier if budgets are near-zero (since no free tier). Overall, its weaknesses are minor for most, but it relies on coaches bringing their own programming expertise.

Volt Athletics – Strengths: Volt's big advantage is its **intelligent programming** and breadth of content. It effectively acts as a virtual strength coach – leveraging expert-designed programs and AI adjustments to deliver quality training without the coach starting from scratch . This is ideal for sport coaches or PE teachers who may be juggling multiple roles ("wearing multiple hats") and have limited time to design workouts . Volt brings efficiency: it can quickly generate periodized plans, then adapt to athlete feedback (e.g., if an athlete rates a workout too easy, Volt will raise the weights next time via Smart Sets). The platform is very **user-friendly** for athletes: having video demos and clear instructions on every exercise lowers the skill barrier for

14-18 year-olds learning lifting . Volt also supports remote training well – coaches can manage teams from afar and athletes can access workouts anywhere (even offline) . In short, Volt's strengths are **time-saving and guidance**: it provides sound, NSCA-approved training programs efficiently and helps ensure proper technique and progression for each athlete.

Volt Athletics – Weaknesses: The flip side of Volt's ready-made approach is somewhat less **flexibility** for coaches who have their own training philosophy. While Volt does allow custom workout creation (especially in Advanced tier), its core approach is to use its templates/AI – some highly experienced S&C coaches might find this limiting if Volt's programming style doesn't match their preferences. Another weakness is that some advanced features (like custom program building, wellness surveys, or even in-app messaging) are locked into higher-priced tiers – a small high school program on the Essentials plan might not get those perks. Also, because Volt's value is in its algorithms, there can be a bit of a "black box" feel; coaches might not have transparency on how exactly loads are calculated behind the scenes. In terms of data analytics, Volt does provide basic analytics and progress tracking, but it may not offer the depth of custom reporting that a platform like TeamBuildr does. Lastly, Volt's pricing (floor of ~$800/year) could be a stretch for very small programs, especially if they don't need the full library of features. It's a powerful tool, but one somewhat **prescriptive** in nature – great for guidance, less so for bespoke coaching methods.

TrainHeroic – Strengths: TrainHeroic shines in **engaging athletes** and straightforward workout delivery. Its focus on strength & conditioning means it offers robust tools for building training programs and tracking performance, similar to TeamBuildr . Many coaches enjoy features like **leaderboards and competition** among team members, which can motivate high school athletes to push harder. It also has a marketplace of programs, so coaches can draw inspiration or even purchase programs from others. TrainHeroic is relatively easy to get started with – coaches can quickly upload workouts and invite athletes. The app experience for athletes is polished and game-like, appealing to younger users. It's also somewhat modular in cost: you pay for what you use in terms of athlete count, so a small team can start at a very low monthly cost (budget-friendly for a single coach training a few athletes). Essentially, TrainHeroic's strengths are in being **coach-friendly for programming** and **fun for athletes**, making training feel interactive and competitive.

TrainHeroic – Weaknesses: Its pricing model, while flexible, can become a **cost disadvantage** as a team grows – larger programs may find it more expensive than a flat-rate system. Unlike some competitors, TrainHeroic isn't an all-in-one solution (it doesn't handle things like payments or gym management – which isn't a concern for a school team, but worth noting). It's mostly focused on the training itself. Some users note that TrainHeroic can be *niche-limited* – it's great for S&C, but if a coach wanted integrated wellness tracking or academic content, that's not its domain. It also lacks custom branding options (not a big issue for school use). In comparison to TeamBuildr, it may have slightly fewer analytic/report options (its "monitoring" features exist but are not as extensive) . Another possible weakness is reliance on every athlete consistently using the app to get the full benefit (if some athletes don't log their workouts, the coach's data will be incomplete, and there's no alternative like a dedicated kiosk mode in basic plans).

Overall, TrainHeroic is strong in core function but not as **feature-rich** beyond programming and tracking.

PLT4M – Strengths: PLT4M's unique strength is its **breadth of content tailored for education**. It not only provides strength programs but also ready-made curricula for fitness, conditioning, and more, which is perfect for high school settings . For a high school coach who is also a teacher, having structured lesson plans for weight training classes and a progression from 7th grade newcomers to varsity athletes is a huge plus . The platform is built for inclusivity – covering all fitness levels and offering modifications based on available equipment . It also allows multiple teachers/coaches to collaborate (unlimited instructor accounts) , which is great for larger schools. PLT4M is often noted for **excellent support and onboarding**; they provide training to staff and are very responsive, knowing that some users might not be tech-savvy coaches. Data tracking and reports in PLT4M are straightforward, helping teachers with grading or coaches with monitoring progress. Another strength is **value for money** when a school uses it broadly – since one subscription can serve PE classes, off-season programs, and sports teams together, it can justify its cost easily if fully utilized .

PLT4M – Weaknesses: Because PLT4M tries to serve broad PE and wellness needs, serious athletes or veteran strength coaches might find it a bit **generalized**. Its training programs are solid but not sport-specific to the degree Volt's are (though they cover foundational lifts well). While you can input your own workouts, PLT4M might not have some of the high-end performance analytics that a pure S&C platform does – for instance, it's more about ensuring all students are improving than about advanced metrics or linking complex exercise variations. The user interface is built for simplicity (for teenage students and busy teachers), which means it may not have highly granular controls that a strength coach geek might desire. Additionally, the pricing model could be a hurdle if a single team sport is trying to adopt it outside of a whole-school purchase – convincing a school to pay for a platform that won't be used school-wide could be tough. In short, PLT4M can be seen as **less specialized** in hardcore strength coaching features (e.g., no AI, fewer pro-level analytics), focusing instead on approachability and educational content.

Market Gaps & Opportunities

Despite the strengths of these platforms, there are notable gaps and niches in the market:

- **Cost and Accessibility for Small Programs:** All major solutions require a significant recurring cost. A small high school or youth team with a tight budget might struggle to afford $600+ per year. There's an opportunity for a **low-cost or free solution** for teams that can't allocate funds to software. Additionally, the need to have technical support or onboarding can be a barrier for volunteer coaches. A simpler, perhaps open-source tool that a coach can use without corporate subscriptions could fill this niche.

- **Overbuilt vs. Simplicity:** Some teams find existing platforms to be overkill. If a coach just wants to generate workout sheets with correct weights and basic tracking, they might not need messaging systems, leaderboards, or extensive analytics. The current market has few

streamlined tools – it's either spreadsheets or a full SaaS platform. This leaves a gap for a **streamlined program** that automates key tasks (like calculating training weights) without a ton of extra features. Essentially, something that sits between Excel and enterprise software.

- **Integration with Existing Workflows:** Many coaches still use **Google Sheets or Excel** to plan and record workouts because it's familiar, flexible, and free. The big platforms require moving all data into their system. There's an opportunity for solutions that **integrate with Google Sheets or other common tools**, letting coaches keep their current workflow but supercharging it with automation. For example, none of the major platforms directly plug into Google Sheets in real-time – a tool that does so could attract coaches who have years of data in spreadsheets and don't want to start over.

- **Automatic Strength Estimation and Data Science:** Handling incomplete data is a pain point. If an athlete misses a max test day, coaches often have to guess appropriate weights or use generic percentage formulas. Most commercial platforms don't explicitly offer a feature to *simulate or estimate* an athlete's max based on partial data (aside from Volt's AI adjusting over time, or TeamBuildr's ability to link known maxes). A program that can **estimate "functional max" values conservatively when data is missing** would fill a gap – ensuring safe training loads without manual guesswork. Similarly, more advanced analytics (beyond what high school coaches typically do) could be a niche: for instance, projecting progress, identifying plateaus automatically, or personalized load adjustments based on confidence. These data-driven approaches are not fully realized in many current offerings.

- **Customization and Ownership of Data:** Schools might also be interested in a solution where they fully **own their data and process**. With subscription platforms, if you stop paying, you might lose access or the data could be less portable. An open-source or self-hosted program allows a team to maintain control over their athlete data (maxes, workouts, results) in a format like Google Sheets or CSV. This could appeal to more tech-savvy coaches or districts with privacy concerns. The opportunity here is a **niche product for tech-friendly coaches** who want maximum customization and no lock-in – something current mass-market apps don't prioritize.

In summary, existing programs are excellent but tend to be either high-cost, feature-heavy solutions or entirely manual spreadsheets. There's a market opportunity for a **lightweight, cost-effective tool that automates strength programming basics**, integrates with familiar tools, and perhaps offers unique analytics (like conservative max estimation) that others lack. This is precisely where a custom lifting program could carve out a niche.

Comparing the Custom Lifting Program to Market Leaders

The provided README describes a **lifting program automation tool** built for a high school football strength program . It reads data from Google Sheets, calculates assigned workout weights from athletes' tested maxes using preset multipliers, and simulates missing data to estimate a conservative "functional max" for safety . Key features include Google Sheets integration, dynamic weight assignments, confidence-based strength simulations, and a data

dashboard for analysis . Let's evaluate how this custom program compares to TeamBuildr, Volt, and others:

Where the Program Excels

- **Seamless Google Sheets Integration:** This is a standout difference. The custom program works directly with Google Sheets (reading from *CompleteProgram* and *Maxes* tabs and writing outputs) . Coaches already using Sheets can continue without migrating data to a new platform. None of the big commercial tools offer this level of integration with a spreadsheet – this program fills that gap by **enhancing an existing workflow** instead of replacing it.

- **Automated Weight Calculations:** The tool automatically computes training weights based on each athlete's max and the prescribed multipliers for each set . This saves coaches significant time. In a manual spreadsheet, a coach might otherwise plug in formulas or hand-calc percentages. TeamBuildr or TrainHeroic can do percentage-based weights too, but only within their system. This program does it in Sheets, meaning a coach gets the convenience of automation without needing a separate app. It's a **streamlined solution** for assigning personalized loads to every athlete, ideal for managing a team of 30+ with varied strength levels.

- **Conservative Strength Estimation:** A unique feature is the "confidence-based simulations" to estimate **Functional Max Strength** when data is missing . In practice, if an athlete hasn't tested a lift recently, the program simulates a likely max (presumably using past data or general progress models) but errs on the side of caution. This ensures the assigned training weights are safe and not overestimated. This kind of automatic max estimation is not explicitly present in TeamBuildr or Volt (coaches usually have to input a max or the software adjusts after a few sessions). By providing an estimated max, the program helps coaches deal with incomplete data **without guesswork**, reducing injury risk from too-heavy assignments. It effectively brings a bit of "built-in sports science" to a spreadsheet.

- **Data Dashboard & Analysis:** The README mentions a data dashboard output for training analysis . Likely, the program summarizes key metrics (perhaps showing each athlete's weekly progress or identifying who is hitting their targets). While the extent of this isn't fully clear, having a **custom dashboard in Google Sheets** can be powerful. The coach can see all their team's info at a glance, and because it's in Sheets, they can tweak or add graphs as desired. This is an advantage in flexibility – commercial platforms have set dashboards, but this custom one can be adapted or extended by the coach. It provides insights without needing an expensive analytics module.

- **Low Cost & Ownership:** Being a project built with Python and Google API, this program is presumably open-source or at least free for the school to use (aside from potential Google API costs, which are minimal for modest use). This is a major advantage: **no subscription fees**. For a small program with no budget, using this tool only costs the effort to set it up. Additionally, the school owns all the data (it's all in their Google Sheets) and can

continue using it indefinitely. This cost and data ownership model is a big plus over any commercial offering for those who have the capability to use it.

- **Customization Potential:** Since this is a self-developed script, it can be modified to fit evolving needs. If the coach wants to add a new calculation or adjust the logic, they (or a developer) can alter the Python code. That's far more customizable than closed-source platforms. For example, if the coach decides to incorporate a new lift or change how multipliers are determined, they have direct control. This means the program can **adapt with the program's philosophy** year to year, something static commercial apps can't easily do for an individual user. It's truly a solution "by the coach, for the coach."

Areas for Improvement

- **User Interface & Ease of Use:** The custom program currently runs via Python scripts and Google Sheets. For a non-technical coach, the setup (installing Python 3.8+, dealing with Google Cloud credentials) could be daunting . In contrast, TeamBuildr or Volt offer polished UIs and mobile apps out-of-the-box. This program lacks a dedicated mobile app or slick UI – athletes likely see their workouts in a Google Sheet or printed paper. Google Sheets on a phone is functional but not very user-friendly for a 15-year-old entering workout data. So, **ease of use for athletes (and less tech-savvy coaches)** is an issue. Improving this might involve creating a simple web interface or using Google Forms for data entry to make it more approachable.

- **Real-Time Tracking and Athlete Engagement:** With the current setup, athletes aren't interacting with a tailored app, which means features like instant feedback, leaderboards, or messaging are absent. Platforms like TrainHeroic and TeamBuildr excel in engaging athletes (alerts, badges, leaderboards for PRs, etc.), which can motivate students. The custom program would benefit from finding ways to increase athlete engagement – perhaps by adding a Google Form for athletes to submit how many reps they got (to track PRs), or by generating a leaderboard tab in the Sheet. At present, it's more of a coach's tool than an interactive athlete tool. **Adding engagement features** could help it compete with the "fun factor" of other apps.

- **Breadth of Features:** The tool focuses on weight assignment and max estimation, which it does well. However, it doesn't currently handle things like scheduling, communications, or varied program content (e.g., tracking conditioning workouts, agility drills, etc.). Commercial platforms offer a one-stop shop for all training activities. If the high school program needs to track more than just core lifts (say conditioning test results or accessory exercises), the custom program might need further development. Also, advanced features like video demonstrations, technique coaching tips, or wellness questionnaires are beyond its scope right now. **Expanding the feature set carefully** (without ruining its simplicity) may be needed to prevent it from feeling too narrow compared to competitors.

- **Platform Compatibility Limits:** The README notes it's been tested on Linux/macOS, with Windows compatibility not fully verified . Many high school coaches use Windows PCs – so this could be a practical limitation. Also, running a Python script might not fit seamlessly into every workflow (some coaches might prefer a click-button solution or a cloud

app). Ensuring it can run on Windows or even moving to a Google Apps Script (to run entirely in the cloud) could improve accessibility. Additionally, while Google Sheets is accessible on any device, if the internet is down or the Google API quota is hit, the tool might not work at that moment. The program could improve robustness by adding an offline mode (perhaps caching data or allowing a local CSV input).

- **Support and Maintenance:** With a commercial product, you usually have support if things break. With a custom script, the coach or developer must troubleshoot. The README does highlight error handling for robustness , but issues can still arise (API changes, sheet format changes, etc.). For long-term use, documentation and ease of maintenance will be crucial. If the original developer leaves, will the coaching staff be able to continue using it? Investing in clear documentation (which the README is already providing) and perhaps simplifying how others can run it (maybe a one-click Google Colab or a small web app) would help. In short, it needs to be **foolproof for non-developers** to truly rival paid solutions.

Marketing & Positioning Strategies

To stand out in the competitive space, the custom lifting program should emphasize its unique value propositions and target the right niche:

- **"Budget-Friendly Automation":** Market the program as a **free or low-cost alternative** to expensive strength software. Emphasize that schools can save hundreds of dollars a year by using this tool without sacrificing quality in their programming. For many athletic directors or booster clubs, cost is king – positioning the program as delivering 80% of the functionality for 0% of the price will draw attention. Terms like "open-source," "no subscription required," or "budget-friendly" should be front and center.

- **"Built for Coaches, by Coaches":** Highlight that this program was developed within a high school football context, meaning it understands the **real-world needs of school teams**. Marketing can stress how the tool focuses on exactly what coaches need (assigning weights, tracking maxes) without unnecessary bells and whistles. In contrast to generic fitness apps, this is a **tailored solution for high school strength programs**. Including testimonials or examples (e.g., "Coach X saved 5 hours a week using this automation in Google Sheets") could resonate with other coaches.

- **Integration with Existing Tools:** Pitch the program as a **companion to Google Sheets**. Many coaches are proud of their Excel/Sheets programs – instead of asking them to ditch those, this tool enhances them. A slogan might be "Keep your Google Sheets – let our tool do the heavy lifting (calculations) for you." By positioning it as an upgrade to a familiar workflow, it lowers the barrier for adoption. Coaches don't have to learn a whole new system, they just run this alongside their Sheet. This positions the program not as a daunting new software, but as a helpful assistant.

- **Safety and Smarter Training:** Leverage the unique **"confidence-based simulation"** feature as a selling point. Market it as an **intelligent safety net**: "No more

guessing athletes' maxes – our program uses data to estimate safe training weights when tests aren't available." This makes the tool sound smart and innovative, even "AI-light" without needing heavy AI. In an era where data-driven coaching is a buzzword, this feature can be promoted to show the program has a modern, analytical approach (giving it an edge over simple spreadsheets). Coaches concerned about injury prevention will appreciate that it errs on the side of caution automatically.

- **Transparency and Control:** Some coaches may be skeptical of black-box algorithms. Emphasize that this program is transparent – you can see and adjust the formulas or logic if desired. Marketing it as **"100% customizable and transparent"** could attract coaches who feel locked out by proprietary systems. It's like giving them the keys to their own program's software, which is empowering. Also note that data stays in their own Google account – so privacy and ownership are ensured.

- **Community and Support:** Although it's a free tool, building a small community (even if just a forum or GitHub repository) around it can add value. Market it as an evolving project: "continually improved by a community of coaches and developers." This gives confidence that it won't become abandonware. Offering guides, videos, or even personal assistance for initial setup (if feasible) as part of the "product" can alleviate concerns about technical difficulty. Essentially, try to provide a bit of the support structure that a paid product would – maybe through online documentation or Q&A.

- **Targeted Niche:** Initially, focus marketing on similar scenarios: high school football teams, strength coaches who already use spreadsheets, and schools with limited budgets. These are the folks who will most readily see the value. Success stories in this niche can then be used to expand to other sports or small colleges later. By zeroing in on the high school strength niche, the program can brand itself as the **go-to solution for high school strength training automation**, differentiating from broad platforms that try to serve everyone from personal trainers to military.

In conclusion, the custom lifting program holds its own in key areas like automation and data integration, especially for a coach comfortable with Google Sheets. It outshines big-name competitors in cost and specific features like conservative max estimation. With some improvements in usability and scope, it could be a formidable contender for teams that need a simple, effective strength-training management tool. By marketing its **cost-efficiency**, **tailored focus**, and **seamless integration**, this program can carve out a compelling spot in a market dominated by larger, pricier platforms.

Sources:

- TeamBuildr features and benefits ; pricing tiers .
- Volt Athletics features and tier details ; NSCA review of Volt's benefits .
- TrainHeroic and competitor info .

- PLT4M platform focus and usage in schools ; pricing model .
- SimpliFaster buyer’s guide on coaching software (TeamBuildr, TrainHeroic, PLT4M, MaxOne) .
- README of custom lifting program (features and workflow) .